

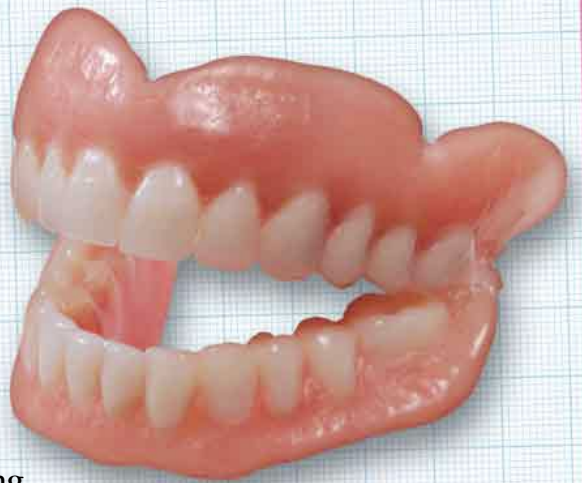


Contact lenses

Early contact lenses were made of **HARD GLASS** and were often very uncomfortable to wear. Czech chemist **Otto Wichterle** experimented at home with hydrogels (types of polymer material that hold water). In 1961, he built a machine on his kitchen table out of **parts from a child's construction kit** and a record player motor. It spun out tiny disks of the material, which formed the first comfortable soft contact lenses.

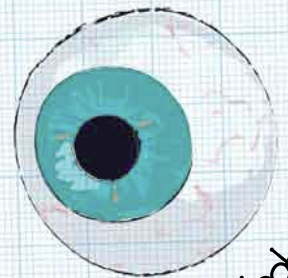
Dentures

Many kinds of **FALSE TEETH**, also known as dentures, have been in use over centuries. The Etruscans in northern Italy made dentures from human and animal teeth starting in 700 BCE. George Washington, the first president of the United States, wore dentures **carved out of hippopotamus ivory** and held in place by springs made of gold wire. Modern dentures are made from **plastics**, and are colored and shaped to look like the real thing.



Pacemaker

Some people's hearts don't beat at a healthy rate or rhythm. Pacemakers help by sending out small **ELECTRICAL PULSES** to stimulate the heart muscles. One of the first, built by Canadian **John Hopps** in 1950, was the size of a toaster and needed to be plugged into a wall socket. Nine years later came a successful **implantable** pacemaker placed completely inside the body. Some patients lived for 30 years with this model, developed by Americans **Wilson Greatbatch** and **William Chardack**.



Glass eyeballs don't help people see but look realistic.